CityU AI Workshop
Use Case Ideation

October, 2026

Let’s have some warm-up exercises

- Raise your right hand! Then, left hand!
- Clap your hands!
- 3, 2, 1 ... Shout out your name!

Hands-on workshop agenda

Topics	Time	Items
		Introduction
Improve **Your Prompts**	15 min	Prompt / Context Engineering
Identify **Opportunities with JTBD**	30 min	Jobs-To-Be-Done framework
Define **Problem Statements with DT**	45 min	Design Thinking framework
Share **Your Problem Statements**	30 min	Share The Top 3
Ideate **Possible Solutions**	15 min	Some sample prompts
		Conclusion and next steps

Improve Your Prompts



Describe what you see ... 15 seconds



What the AI sees … 5 seconds



The image features a **McLaren Formula 1 car** (specifically the **MCL36** model or a later evolution) captured in a high-speed profile shot during a night session.

What the AI sees ... 5 seconds



The Car & Livery

Livery: The car uses McLaren's signature "Papaya" orange combined with matte black (exposed carbon fiber). There are also distinct light blue (cyan) accents along the sidepods.

Sponsors: Major logos include Android (with the green robot mascot), Google Chrome, Tezos, Dewalt, and Alteryx.

What the AI sees ... 5 seconds



Wheel Covers: A standout feature is the Google Chrome-themed wheel covers, which display a glowing, circular rainbow pattern. This effect mimics the colors of the Chrome browser logo and was introduced as part of McLaren's partnership with Google.

What the AI sees ... 5 seconds



The Scene & Photography

Setting: The photo is taken at a race track at night, likely during a race like the Bahrain Grand Prix or Saudi Arabian Grand Prix, indicated by the floodlights and dark background.

What the AI sees ... 5 seconds



Motion: The image uses a panning technique, which keeps the car in sharp focus while the background (pit walls and barriers) is heavily blurred.

Action: You can see bright orange sparks flying from the bottom of the car, caused by the titanium skid block on the floor of the chassis making contact with the track surface at high speed.

And the Prompt ...

"A side-profile, cinematic action shot of a modern Formula 1 car racing at night on a floodlit desert circuit.

The car features a vibrant matte papaya orange and carbon fiber black livery with cyan accents. The wheel covers are glowing with a futuristic, circular rainbow neon effect.

Sparks are flying from the titanium skid block underneath the chassis.

The background is a high-speed motion blur of track barriers and stadium lights, captured with a long exposure aesthetic, ultra-realistic, 8k resolution, sports photography style."

What AI generates ...



What AI generates ...





What AI generates ...



With a well-crafted prompt, AI is capable of generating excellent and useful content, but not 100% the same



Prompt / Context is key!

Tips for writing **Image** prompts

1. **Subject:** The main focal point, such as a person, animal, or object.
2. **Action/Context:** What the subject is doing or where they are located.
3. **Environment/Background:** Details of the surroundings, such as "cluttered office" or "neon-lit street".
4. **Style & Lighting:** Artistic style (e.g., Oil painting, 3D render) and lighting conditions (e.g., Cinematic, dramatic, soft).
5. **Composition & Technical Details:** Camera angles (e.g., Close-up, wide-angle) and specific visual styles (e.g., Photorealistic).

Prompt:

[Subject]
+ [Action/Context]
+ [Environment]
+ [Style/Lighting]
+ [Technical Details]

Prompt / Context is key!

Tips for writing Video prompts

1. **Subject (Who/What):** Define the main focus clearly. Describe appearance, clothing, and expression in detail to ensure consistency.
2. **Action (What is happening):** The verb of the video. Describe the motion clearly to drive the narrative.
3. **Scene/Context (Where):** The environment or background. Include details like time of day, weather, and setting to establish atmosphere.
4. **Camera Movement (How it's filmed):** Define the camera's perspective and movement. Use cinematic terms like "slow push-in," "tracking shot," "pan left," or "low-angle shot".
5. **Style & Lighting (The Mood):** Set the aesthetic, such as "cinematic," "photorealistic," "film noir," or "3D animation." Define lighting, such as "soft natural light," "backlit," or "neon-lit".

Prompt:

[Subject]
+ [Action]
+ [Scene]
+ [Camera Movement]
+ [Style/Lighting]

Generate storyboard images, video and voiceover

Prompt:

1 prompt returns multiple images

Create an image storyboard for young boy becoming a superhero and saving people. I give you the creative freedom to make up the story












Prompt / Context is key!

Tips for writing **Business** prompts

1. **Use personas:** Define who you are
2. **Define the audience:** Who will be benefiting from your output
3. **Add constraints:** Any business constraints - timeline, cost, markets etc.
4. **Task information:** What do you want?
5. **(Optional) Encourage wild ideas:** Relax some boundaries if needed
6. **(Optional) Give examples:** Provide examples
7. **Format the output:** Bullet points, structural data format?

Prompt:

[Personas]
+ [Audience]
+ [Constraints]
+ [Task information]
+ [Output Format]

Prompt / Context is key!

7 Tips for Brainstorming with AI Prompts

Tips for writing AI prompts

1. Use personas
2. Define the audience
3. Add constraints
4. (Optional) Encourage wild ideas
5. (Optional) Give examples
6. Format the output
7. (Optional) Get visual

Prompt / Context is key!

Exercise:

Original Prompt:

Design a 21” carry-on suitcase



Design your prompt and test it with Gemini


05:00

Prompt / Context is key!

Added Context	Updated Prompt
• Use personas • Define the audience • Add constraints	You're Casetify Travel accessories designer and going to design carry-on suitcase. The target customers are those young IT professionals. The new design suitcase shall be able to customize the color, the logo and font on the front of the suitcase. In addition, there be a TSA-approved lock and easy to retrieve laptop computer. Design a 21" carry-on suitcase

Prompt / Context is key!

Added Context	Updated Prompt
• (Optional) Encourage wild ideas • (Optional) Give examples • Format the output	You're Casetify Travel accessories designer and going to design 21" carry-on suitcase. The target customers are those young IT professionals. The new design suitcase shall be able to customize the color, the logo and font on the front of the suitcase. In addition, there be a TSA-approved lock and easy to retrieve laptop computer. Free to suggest the suitcase materials. Please generate 3 ideas, each expressed in a separate list of features. Number each idea and give it a catchy name. The name and idea should be separated by a dash.

Prompt / Context is key!



Use AI to improve your prompt

Example:

Design a 21” carry-on suitcase

Use AI to improve your prompt

Example:

Design a 21” carry-on suitcase



Please improve the prompt below:

Design a 21” carry-on suitcase

Use AI to improve your prompt

Answers:

1. The Industrial Designer Approach (Functional & Technical)

"Act as an industrial designer.

Design a 21-inch hardshell carry-on suitcase optimized for the frequent business traveler.

Focus on space efficiency and durability. Include features like a dedicated external laptop compartment, silent 360-degree spinner wheels, and a modular interior compression system.

Describe the materials used (e.g., polycarbonate, aerospace-grade aluminum) and provide a list of technical specifications."

Use AI to improve your prompt

Answers:

1. The Industrial Designer Approach (Functional & Technical)

"Act as an industrial designer.

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Describe the materials used (e.g., polycarbonate, aerospace-grade aluminum) and provide a list of technical specifications."

2. The Lifestyle & Aesthetic Approach (Visual & Trendy)

"Create a design concept for a 21-inch luxury carry-on suitcase targeted at Gen Z travelers.

The design should be minimalist yet bold, using a monochromatic color palette with matte finishes.

Incorporate smart technology, such as a built-in USB-C charging port and a digital weight scale in the handle.

Describe the visual silhouette and the 'unboxing' experience for the customer."

Use AI to improve your prompt

Answers:

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3. The Problem-Solver Approach (Innovation-Focused)

"Design a 21-inch carry-on suitcase specifically meant to solve the problem of over-packing and airport security delays.

Propose an innovative layout that allows for 'quick-access' to liquids and electronics without opening the main compartment.

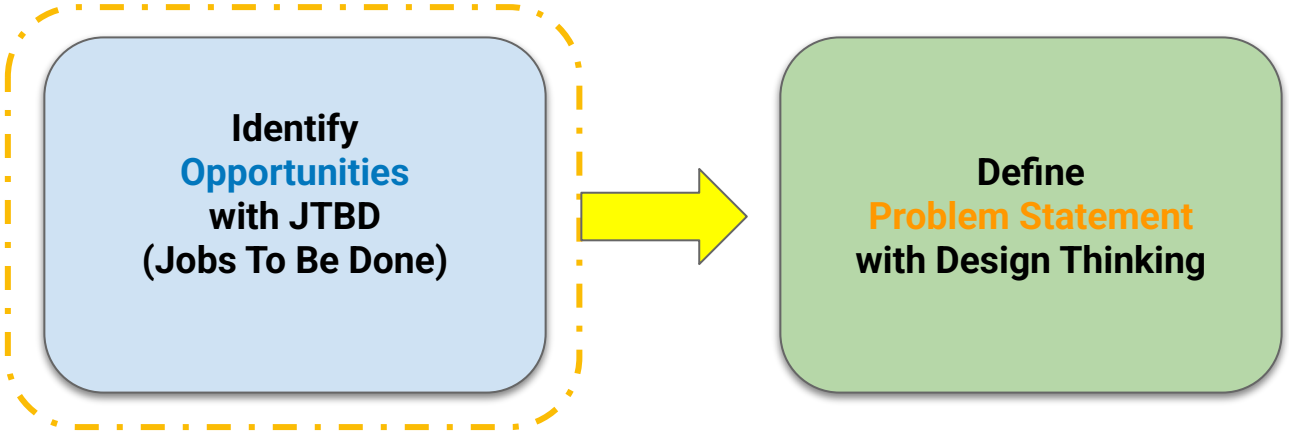
Suggest a sustainable material (like recycled ocean plastics) and explain how the design maximizes the interior volume to meet strict airline dimensions."

Mini summary

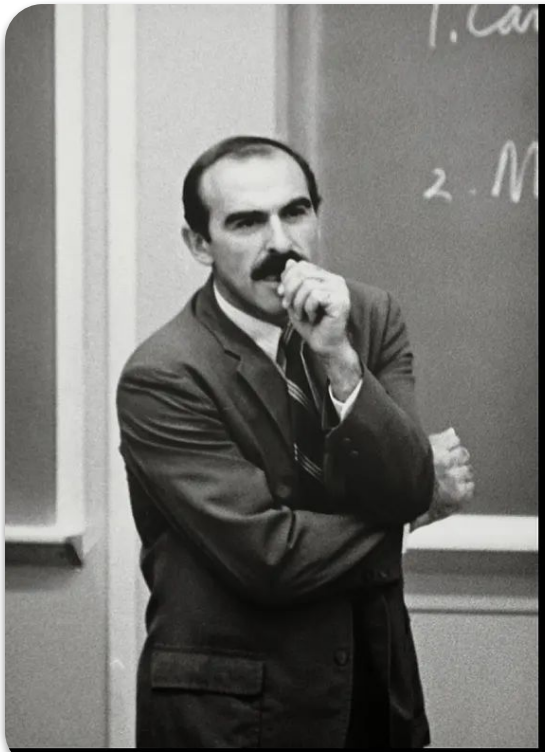
- With **well-crafted prompt**, AI is capable of generating excellent image, video and business content
- **Context** is key!
- Use **AI** to improve your prompt

Identify Opportunities With JTBD (Jobs To Be Done)

B


Identify
Opportunities
with JTBD
(Jobs To Be Done)
Define
Problem Statement
with Design Thinking

What is a Job?



"People don't want to buy a quarter-inch drill. They want a quarter-inch hole!"

Theodore Levitt

What is a Job?

- A job is the **specific task or outcome** a customer is trying to achieve
- Users are struggling to get a **JOB** done
- They are **HIRING** your product to get their **JOB** done
- When **[Situation]**, I want to **[Motivation]**, so I can **[Expected Outcome]**

A Job example

- In North America, a company finds every morning workers buy milkshake in Drive-Thru and then drive to work
- They want to know why - **What is the Job of this?**
- More importantly, **what are the struggles? What are the alternatives?**



A Job example

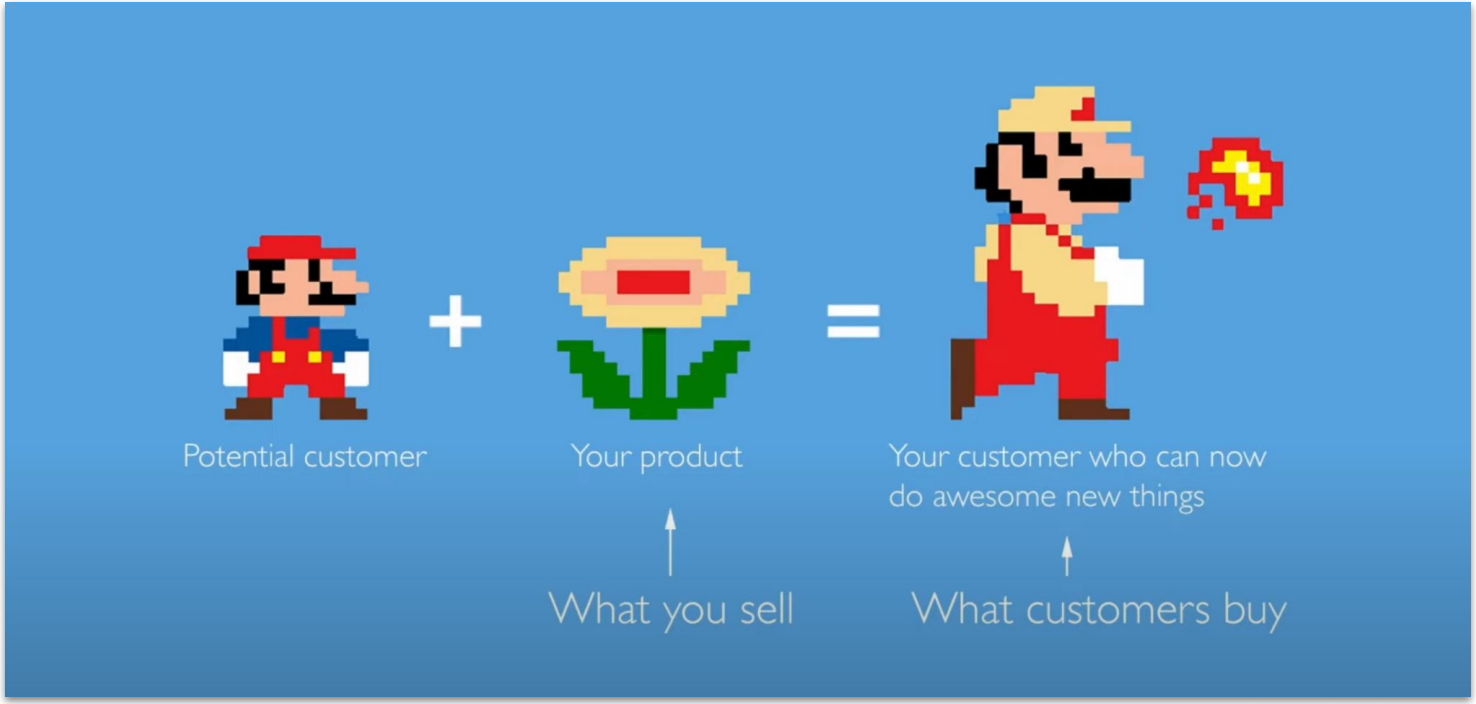
- In North America, a company finds every morning workers buy milkshake in Drive-Thru and then drive to work
- They want to know why - **What is the Job of this?**
- More importantly, **what are the struggles? What are the alternatives?**



Technology advances, but Jobs are the same



In summary ...


Potential customer
Your product
Your customer who can now do awesome new things
What you sell
What customers buy

How to describe a Job? ... Job Stories

When **[Situation]**,
I want to **[Motivation]**,
so I can **[Expected Outcome]**

Job Stories examples, for content creator

When **[Situation]**,
I want to **[Motivation]**,
so I can **[Expected Outcome]**



For Example

When **I am filming a vlog or taking a long-exposure sunset photo**,
I want **a case that integrates seamlessly with tripods or MagSafe accessories**,
so I can **capture stable, high-quality content without fumbling with awkward mounts**

Job Stories examples, for “Night Out”

When **[Situation]**,
I want to **[Motivation]**,
so I can **[Expected Outcome]**



For Example

When **I am going out to a crowded bar or a concert**,
I want **my phone case to securely hold my ID and one credit card**,
so I can **leave my bulky wallet at home and move around freely without losing my essentials**

Use AI to help ...

You're a [Role] of XYZ, an international mobile accessories company, what likely will be the job stories?

Please prepare in the format of "When [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [expected outcome]?

Roles - Mobile phone case Designer, Travel suitcase Designer, Airpod case Designer, Pixel 11 Pro Fold Designer

Teams / Individual to find the Job Stories, with help from AI

Roles - Mobile phone case Designer, Travel suitcase Designer, Airpod case Designer, Pixel 11 Pro Fold Designer

With Gemini, try the prompt following

Record and number the job stories as “When _____ I want to _____ So I can _____”

You have **10** minutes, each pick **the most important job story** from the list

You're a Role of XYZ, an international mobile accessories company, what likely will be the job stories? Please prepare in the format of "When [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [expected outcome]?

Output

Each Team / Individual
with the most important job story

Define the job stories (Opportunities) for each of the roles

Mobile phone case Designer, Travel suitcase Designer, Airpod case Designer, Pixel 11 Pro Fold Designer



You're a Role of XYZ, an international mobile accessories company, what likely will be the job stories? Please prepare in the format of "When [situation], I want to [motivation], so I can [expected outcome]?

Copy down the Job Story to your clipboard / notebook

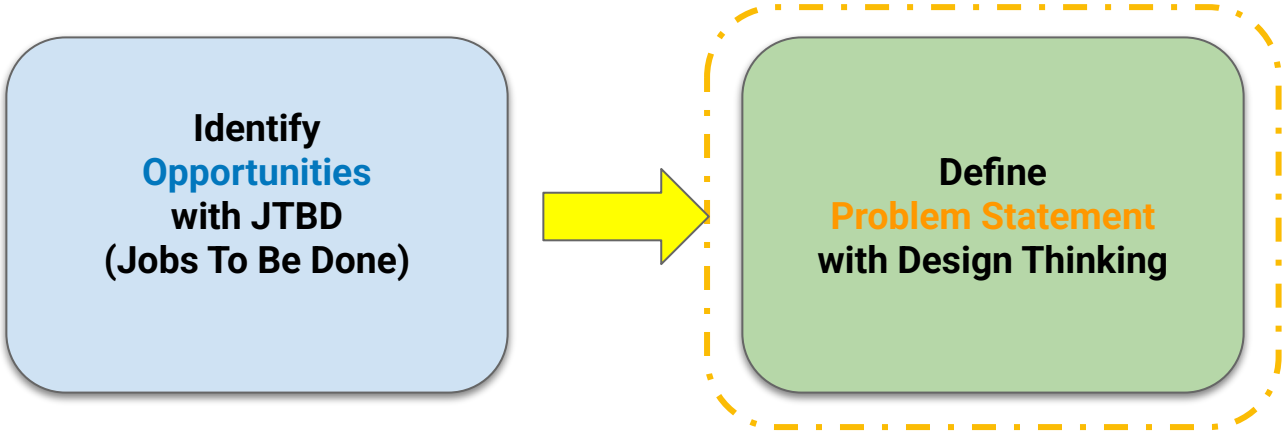
Mini summary

- A job is the specific task or outcome **a customer is trying to achieve**
- **Job Stories** is When [Situation], I want to [Motivation], so I can [Expected Outcome]
- Use **AI** to help you to explore the Job Stories .... And therefore opportunities

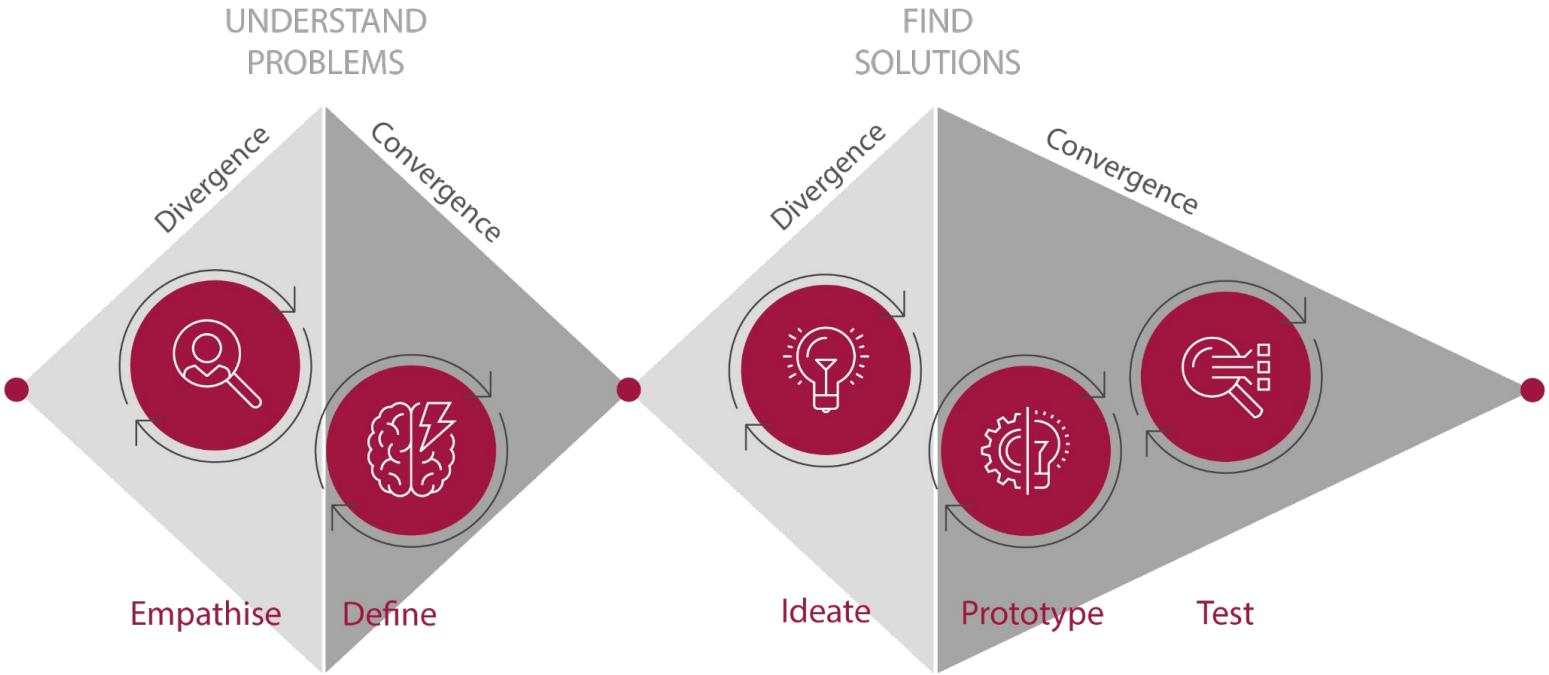
Copy down the Job Story to your clipboard / notebook

Define Problem Statements with Design Thinking

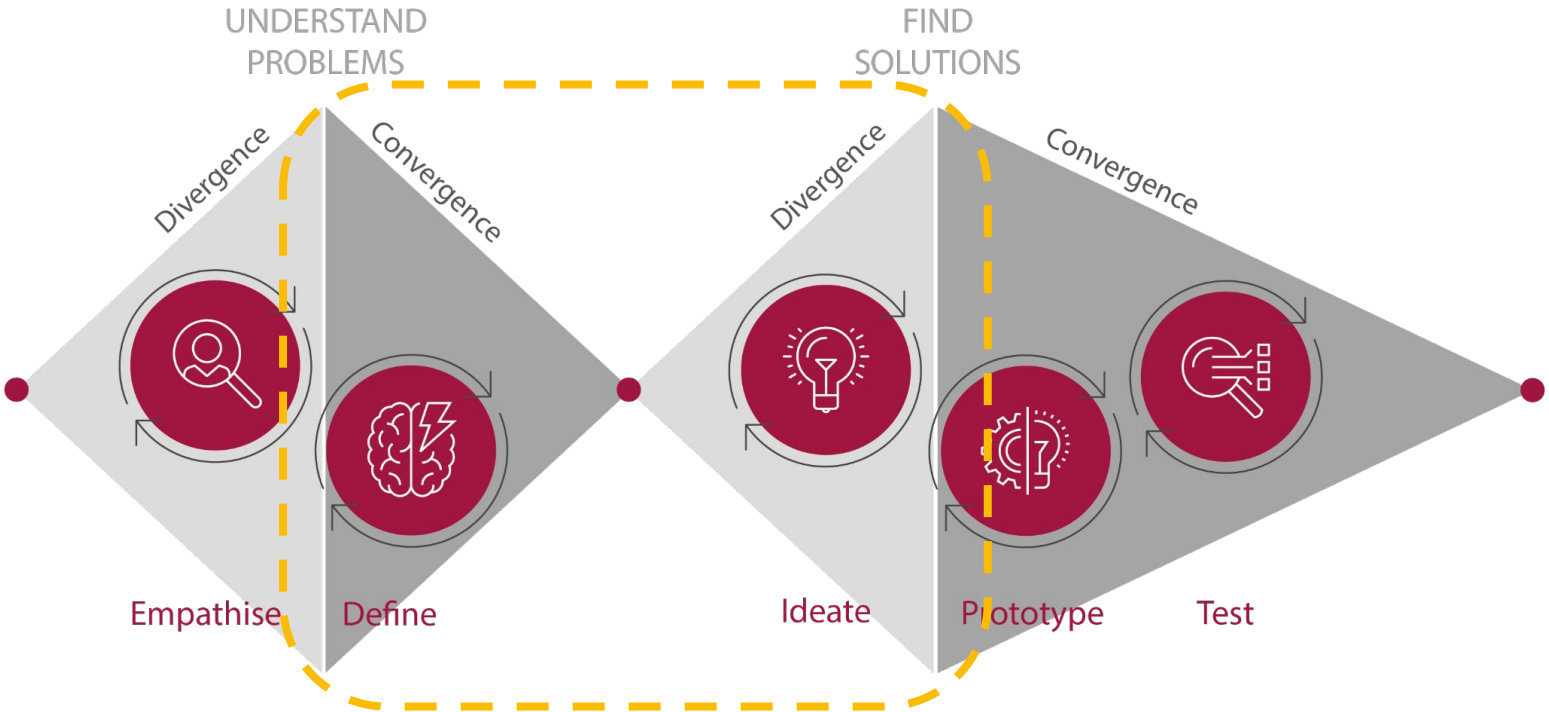
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Identify
Opportunities
with JTBD
(Jobs To Be Done)
Define
Problem Statement
with Design Thinking

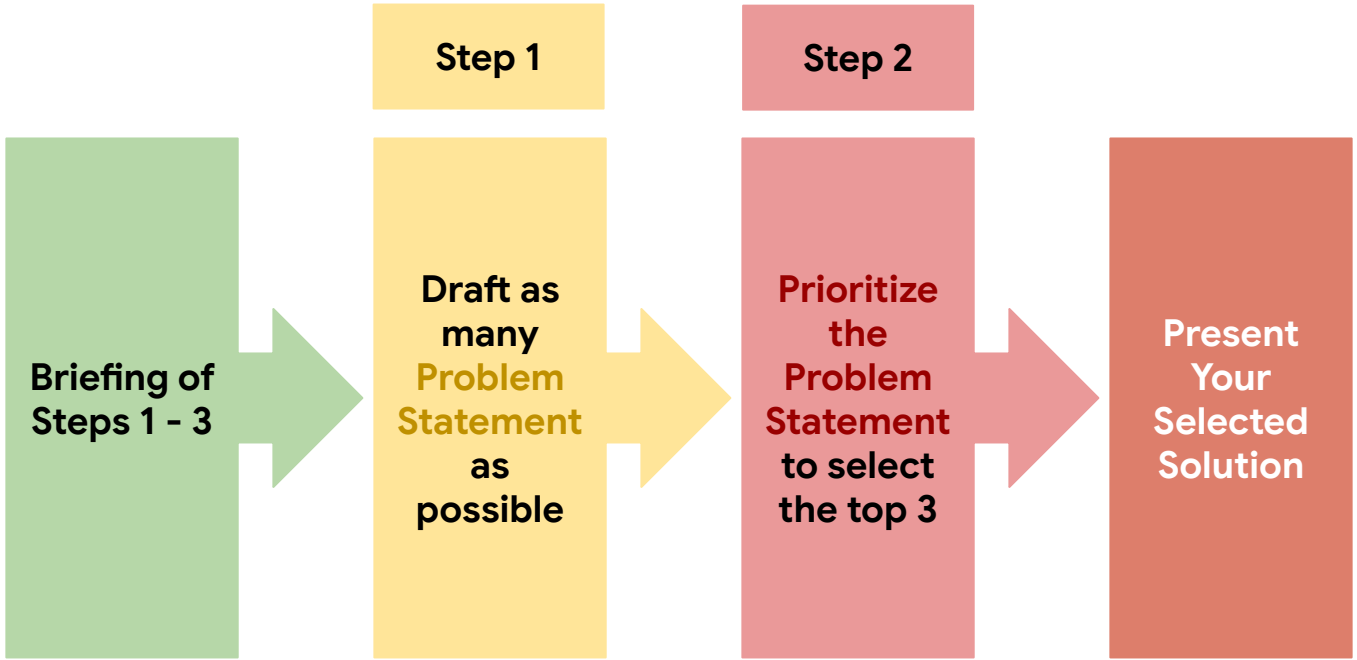
Five stages Design Thinking



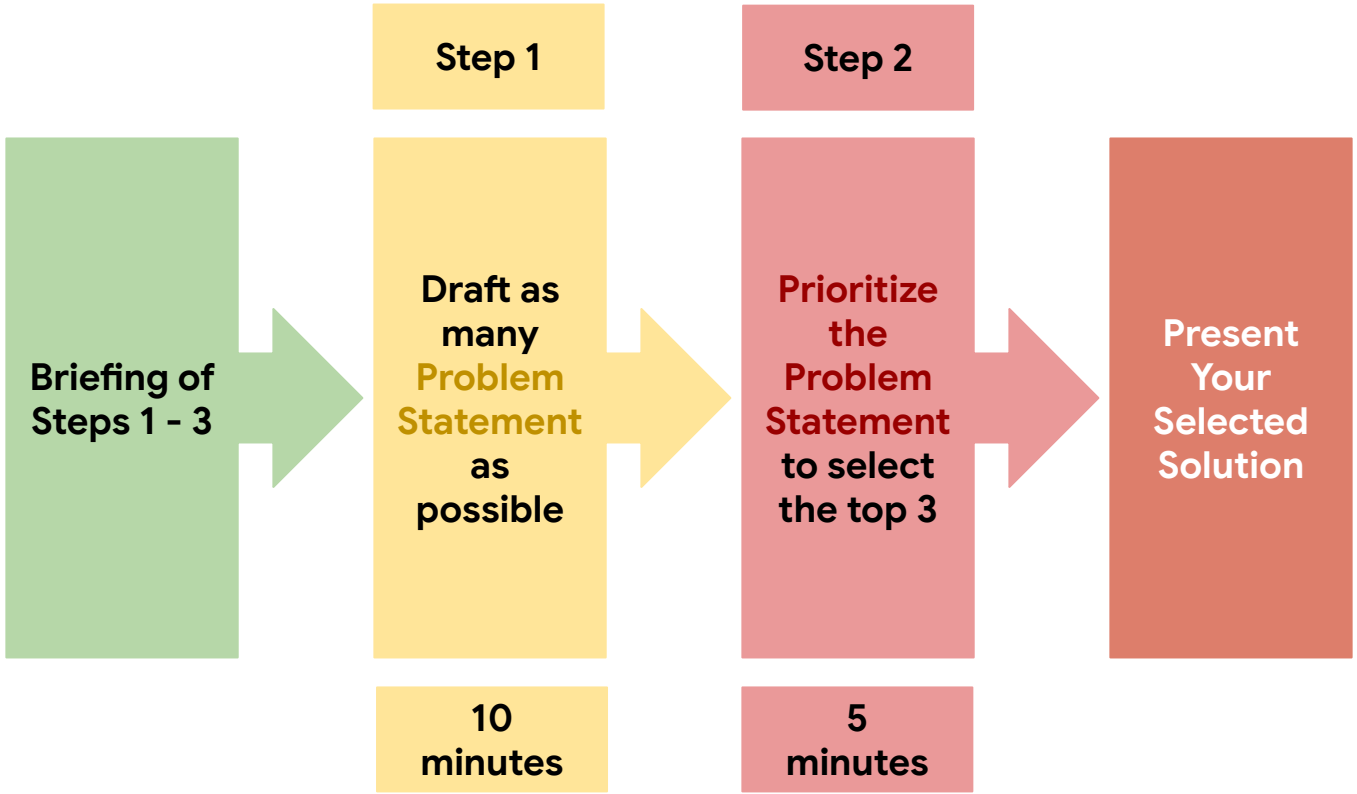
Five stages Design Thinking



What are we gonna do in next 20 minutes?



What are we gonna do in next 20 minutes?



Problem (How Might We) Statements



Problem Statements - How-Might-We structure

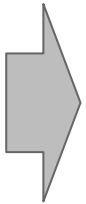
How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to (What change?)

Sample

How Might We improve
the design of the mobile phone case
For executive
In order to increase revenue?

Problem Statements - How-Might-We Structure

How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to (What change?)



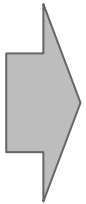
How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to **(Achieve What Job)**

Sample

How Might We improve
the design of the product
For executive
In order to increase revenue?

Problem Statements - How-Might-We Structure

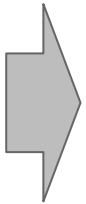
How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to (What change?)



How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to **(Achieve What Job)**

Sample

How Might We improve
the design of the product
For executive
In order to increase revenue?



Sample

How Might We improve
the design of the product
For executive
In order to Achieve Job A
(When I am xxxx, I want to yyyy, so I can zzzz)

Define HMW Statements At Scale



Go for quantity



Write Headlines



Go for big ideas



Be judgemental, later

Output

Each Team / Individual
with lots of HMW statements

#1 - Prepare As Many HMW Statement As Possible

How-Might-We Statement

How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to (What change?)

Sample

How Might We improve
the design of the product
For executive
In order to Achieve Job A?

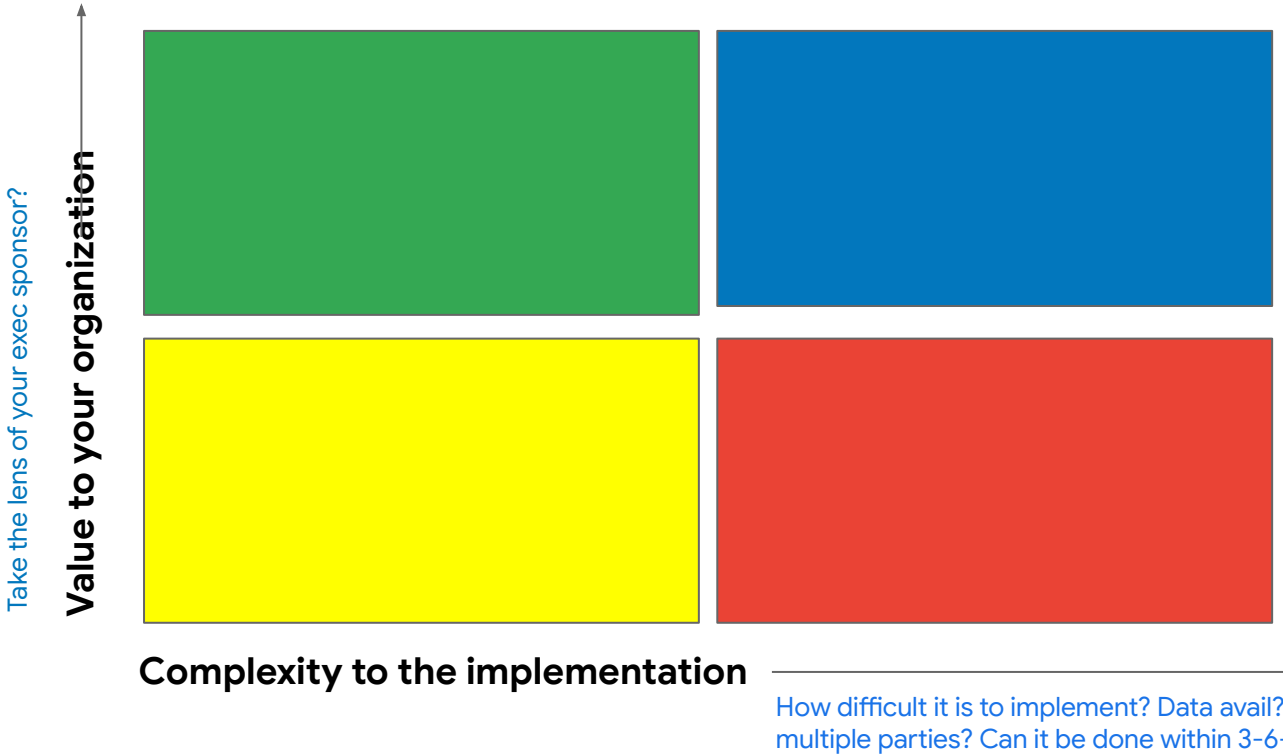


Evaluate and Prioritize HMW Statements



HMW statements evaluation & prioritization

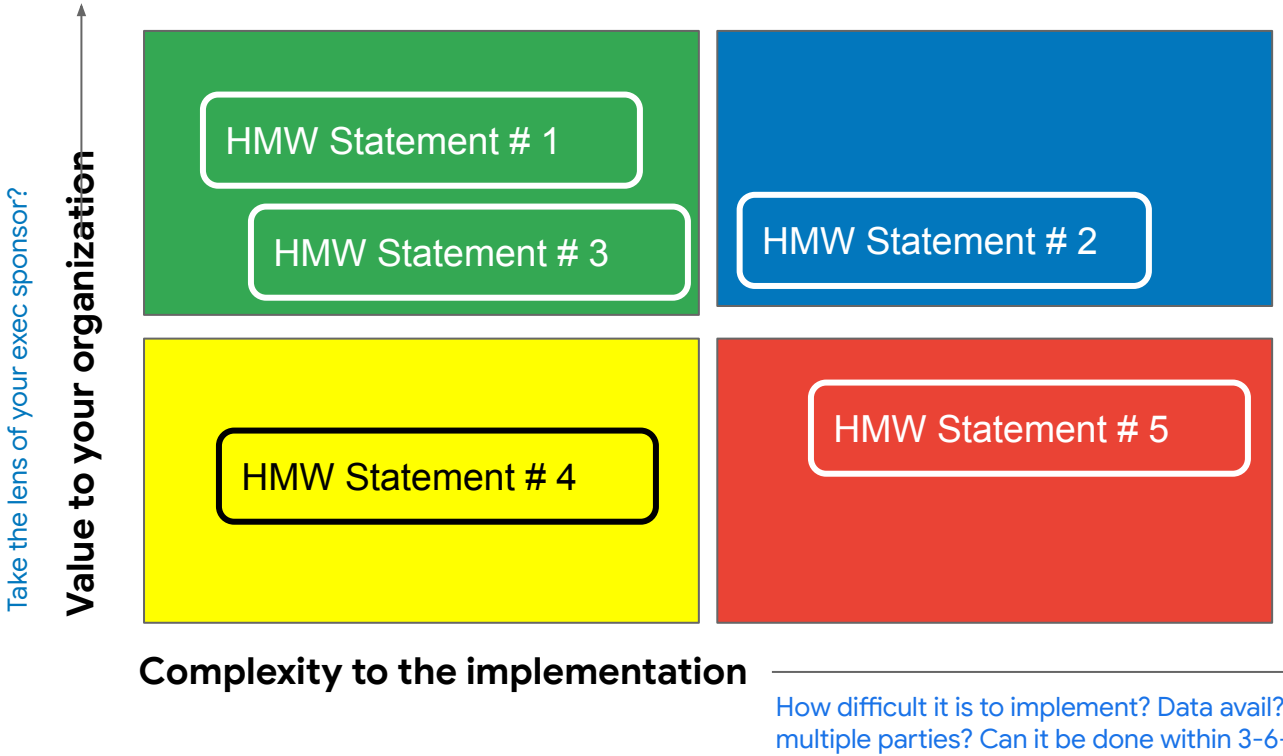
1. Use the large paper, draw up the following 2x2 matrix,



Ideal - Pick HMW Statements in **Green** -> then either **Blue** (long term strategic project) or **Yellow** (low lying fruit, hopefully can reap productivity gains). Bypass **Red**.

HMW statements evaluation & prioritization

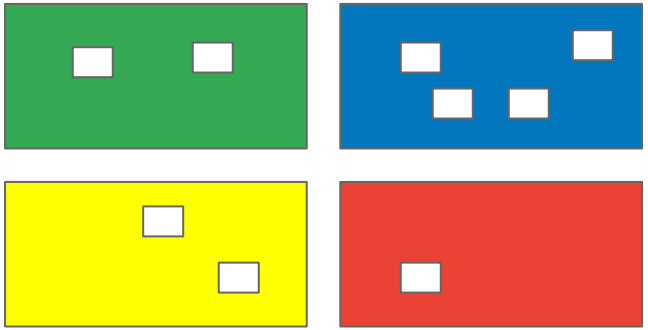
1. Stick the HMW statements, according to value and complexity. Check with IT team or Googlers if needed



Ideal - Pick HMW Statements in **Green** -> then either **Blue** (long term strategic project) or **Yellow** (low lying fruit, hopefully can reap productivity gains). Bypass **Red**.

Pick the top 3 HMW statements

1. Pick the top 3 HMW Statements, use Dot Voting if needed

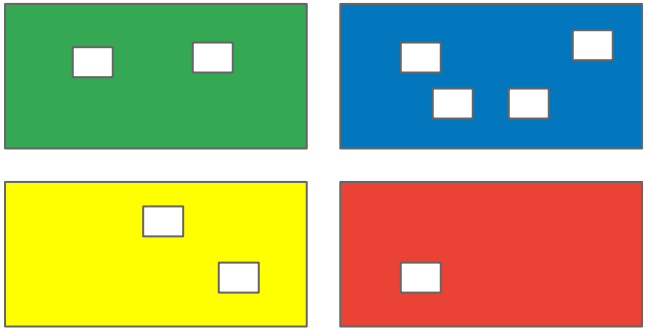


1. Check the GREEN quadrant
2. If there are exactly 3 HMW Statements, just pick these 3
3. If there are more than 3 HMW Statements, use **dot voting** to pick the top 3 (each team members can vote with the color dots provided)
4. If there are less than 3 HMW Statements, pick others from the BLUE quadrant (use dot voting if required)

Output

Each team / individual
with one 2x2 matrix and
3 top HMW statements

Evaluate and prioritize



1. Draw up the 2x2 table with the large white paper
2. Put up the HMW Statements on top of the table
3. Select the top 3 by dot voting



Proprietary + Confidential

Mini summary

- Create problem statements as **How Might We statement**
- **Prioritize** possible HMW Statements with 2x2 matrix
- (Optional) Use Dot Voting to **select the Top 3**

Time To Present Your Opportunity and Top HMW Statements



Mobile phone case Designer,
Travel suitcase Designer,
Airpod case Designer,
Pixel 11 Pro Fold Designer

Each Team:



What's Next?
Ideate Possible Solutions



Proprietary + Confidential

Use AI to ideate

How Might We (Action)
(What)
For (Stakeholder)
In order to **(Achieve What Job)**

Thank you